



SYMBOL
Hand and wheel



JAIN LAL MANDIR TEMPLE
Built in 1658, this is one of the oldest temples in New Delhi, India. Within the ornate buildings there is also a hospital for birds.

JAINISM

Followers of this faith, who are called Jains, mostly live in India. They believe, in common with members of many other religions, that we die and are reborn in a repeating cycle. If a person can become truly spiritual, the soul becomes free. Jains respect all life, including plants and insects, and reject violence.



SYMBOL
Sacred gate

SHINTO

Arising out of Japanese folklore, Shinto developed as a religion more than 2,000 years ago. Followers believe in the existence of divine spirits, or *kami*. At Shinto places of worship, called shrines, people pay respect to the *kami*, and honour them with many rites and festivals.



GATEWAY
The gateway, known as a *torii*, to the Shinto shrine on Miyajima Island in Japan stands in the sea.



SYMBOL
Circle and swords

SIKHISM

The faith was founded in northern India, where many Sikhs today live or have family links. In Sikhism, there is one God, who makes his will known through gurus (teachers). Believers worship regularly in temples known as *gurdwaras*. At a Sikh service there are prayers, a sermon, and hymns from the sacred Sikh book called the Guru Granth Sahib. Meditation is an important part of the religion.



GOLDEN TEMPLE
Built in the state of Punjab, northern India, at the beginning of the 17th century, this famous Sikh temple is sited in the middle of a lake.

DRESS RULES

Male Sikhs always have a beard. Their long hair, which is never cut, is fastened in a bun and covered with a turban.



THE GURU GRANTH SAHIB
The Sikh holy text contains hymns written or collected by gurus.



SYMBOL
Guardian angel



ZOROASTER
The prophet believed that his God, Ahura Mazda, had appeared to him in visions.

ZOROASTRIANISM

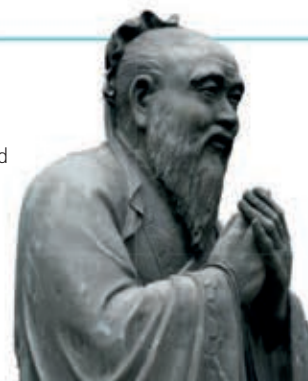
Founded by Zoroaster, a prophet who lived in ancient Persia (now Iran), Zoroastrianism is more than 2,500 years old. Followers believe in Ahura Mazda, the Supreme Creator of the world, and the eternal struggle between good and evil. Their holy book is called the Avesta. Zoroastrians worship in temples, where they hold many ceremonies.



SYMBOL
The Chinese character for water (a life source) is sometimes used.

CONFUCIANISM

This religious philosophy comes from the teachings of Confucius, a 5th-century Chinese thinker and reformer. Kindness, honourable behaviour, and respect for family are key beliefs.



GREAT THINKER
A statue of Confucius stands at the entrance to the Confucian Temple in Shanghai, China.



SYMBOL
Star of David

JUDAISM

This is the religion of the Jewish people, who can trace their roots back to the Hebrews who lived in the Middle East almost 4,000 years ago. Judaism has one God. Followers worship in buildings known as synagogues under the guidance of spiritual leaders called rabbis. Teachings on Judaism are found in the Torah, or Hebrew Bible, and the Talmud, which is the Jewish code of law.



THE WESTERN WALL
Also known as the Wailing Wall, this stone wall in the city of Jerusalem is considered a holy site by Jewish people.

TORAH SCROLL
The scroll, which contains the Torah handwritten in Hebrew, is read in the synagogue.

MENORAH
The menorah, or seven-branched candlestick, is an important Jewish symbol.



SYMBOL
Divine Eye

CAO DAI

Originating in Vietnam, Cao Dai was founded in 1926. The faith takes some of its practices from other religions, including Roman Catholicism and Buddhism. Followers of Cao Dai would like to see all people living at peace with each other. They worship a Supreme Being and honour many saints.



TAY NINH TEMPLE
This elaborate building at Tay Ninh in Vietnam is the most important temple of the Cao Dai faith.

INDIGENOUS RELIGIONS

From Africa to the Americas, indigenous religions are found among remote peoples untouched by the major faiths. These religions, which include the widespread practice of shamanism, often involve contact with the spirits.

BELIEF IN PROTECTION
Followers of indigenous religions often carry objects – like this African nutshell doll – as protection against harm.

